highly subsidized prices is also meant to retain rural workers in their homes and villages.

These policies and programmes have to drastically change to provide proactive support for migration away from agriculture. A massive skill development programme needs to be launched with the express objective of preparing farmers and agriculture workers for the industrial and services sector—to work in mines, quarries, construction, manufacturing, sports, travel, entertainment and other services. The government must incentivize the creation of decent transitional rental arrangements in cities for rural people to come and look for jobs. It also needs to encourage labour-intensive industries to specifically absorb transitioning workers.

A policy framework that can deliver $1 trillion output from agriculture and allied services with only 10 per cent of India's workforce working in agriculture is the ticket to build a $10 trillion economy by 2035 and eliminate poverty.

Shift Focus from Production and Productivity to Farmers' Income

Today, India is not only self-sufficient in food production but has become a significant exporter of agricultural products. While Indian agriculture has become atmanirbhar, the Indian farmer has not—this is the irony in the story of the turnaround of agriculture in India. Indian farmers have not seen much change in their fortunes. Farmers and agricultural labourers, who still comprise over 50 per cent of India's workforce, continue to be the poorest income earners.

Ever since Independence, India's agriculture programme strategy focused only on increasing production and productivity. The income of farmers was not a real policy goal. Only in 2014 did the government specifically mention the doubling of farmers' income by 2022 as a policy goal. However, programmes and policies did not change much to attain this goal.